

Here's an example: if you wrote, "Incidences of burglary in the Churchgate area increased in May," you could shorten that to "Churchgate: burglary up in May." That's less than half the space occupied on a slide.

Step 5

Finally, you pretty up your slides using all of PowerPoint's cool features—and there are plenty of them. Again, make no mistake: this step is important. "Prettiiness" might sound flippant, but it's common wisdom that a pretty presentation works its way better into the thought processes of the members of the audience.

We must tell you not to overdo it, though: don't use animations or special effects when it's a "serious" business presentation, and so on.

Why exactly prettiness works, no-one knows for sure; there probably are statistics on how many internalised smiles the font Comic Sans produces in the average presentation attendee in Chicago versus one in Tulsa, but statistics can prove anything. The idea is, formatting and fonts and all that do their act. Only remember: moderation is key.

To recapitulate:

- Sit down, get those cerebral cells to fire, and ideate.
- Prepare a rough presentation, with placeholders for the stuff you can later, such as charts.
- Then do what you consider "real" presentation preparation: add what you must to your rough slides.
- It most certainly isn't over yet. Edit your slides.
- Last but not least, put the cherry on the pudding, smoothen out the edges, and also delete stock phrases from your presentation.

2.1.2 The Meat Of The Matter

Or, if you're vegetarian, "The cabbage of the content." Either way, we're talking about a checklist—essentials your presentation must match up to before it can be, well, presented. Here we go.